UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

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SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP

COLLEGES OF EDUCATION

END OF SEMESTER ONE EXAMINATION FOR LEVEL 200, 2024/2025

COURSE CODE: TEJS 219
COURSE TITLE: POLITICAL HISTORY OF GHANA – CHIEFTAINCY AND BRITISH COLONIAL RULE

DURATION: 2 HOURS

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.
Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

[25 Marks]

INSTRUCTION: Answer ALL questions in this section by selecting the best response to each question.

1. Which of the following tasks would be handled by a Queen Mother in the Akan political organisation?
   A. Collecting tributes from vassal states
   B. Leading the Asafo companies into battle
   C. Selecting candidates for succession to the stool
   D. Serving as custodian of the land
2. The feature of the Akan political system that most effectively balances the power of the *Omanhene is the…*
   A. Abusuapanyin's control over family matters
   B. Asafo companies' military structure
   C. Council of Elders' advisory role
   D. Odikro's administration of local communities

3. What role did priests play among the Ga-Adangbe and the Guan?
   A. Ga-Adangbe priests could install and destool chiefs while Guan priests held both religious and political power
   B. Ga-Adangbe priests served only religious functions while Guan priests controlled trade
   C. Guan priests controlled land distribution while Ga-Adangbe priests controlled military affairs
   D. Guan priests had no political power while Ga-Adangbe priests ruled absolutely

4. The supreme ruler of the Dagomba in the 17th century was the ….
   A. Nayiri
   B. Tindana
   C. Tongrana
   D. Ya-Na

5. The original ancestors of the Mole-Dagbani moved from east of the Lake Chad to northern Ghana because they…
   A. wanted to establish Islam as the dominant religion
   B. were escaping from frequent wars and instability
   C. were invited by indigenous communities to help with agriculture
   D. were searching for gold deposits

6. The factor which most significantly contributed to the ability of the Gonja kingdom to expand under Ndewura Jakpa Lanta was their…
   A. adoption of Islam and literacy
   B. diplomatic marriages with neighbouring states
   C. strategic position along trade routes
   D. superior military tactics and weapons

7. The Denkyira state declined in the early 18th century because?
   A. Agricultural failure led to widespread famine
   B. European traders shifted their alliances to coastal states
   C. Religious conflicts weakened internal cohesion
   D. The harsh rule of Ntim Gyakari provoked rebellion among vassal states

8. The Hogbetsotso festival of the Anlo-Ewe, is celebrated to commemorate the…
   A. alliance between different Ewe groups against common enemies
   B. exodus from Notsie under King Agorkoli
   C. founding of the first Ewe settlement at Keta
   D. victory over Danish colonizers

9. When the Portuguese explorers decided in the 15th century to establish trade with the Gold Coast, they…
   A. built trading posts and developed relationships with local chiefs
   B. established military dominance immediately upon arrival
   C. focused primarily on spreading Christianity
   D. imposed Portuguese language and customs on local populations

10. If a bill passed by the Legislative Council contradicted British interests a British Colonial Governor was
   A. allowed the bill to pass to maintain good relations
   B. permitted to exercise his veto power to reject the bill
   C. immediately forced to resign from his position
   D. made to refer the matter to local chiefs for resolution

11. Under the British indirect rule system, if a District Commissioner needed to implement a new colonial tax policy, he would…
   A. allow chiefs to decide if they wanted to implement the tax
   B. establish separate British tax collection offices
   C. impose the tax directly on individuals
   D. work through traditional chiefs to collect the taxes

12. Crops like cassava, maize, and peanuts introduced from the Americas in the Gold Coast…
   A. had minimal impact on local food systems
   B. led to agricultural transformation and dietary changes
   C. were grown only on European-owned plantations
   D. were rejected due to cultural resistance

13. The Portuguese were interested in forming an alliance with Prester John mainly to…
   A. establish a Christian ally against Muslim powers
   B. gain access to advanced military technology
   C. learn about African agricultural techniques
   D. recruit African soldiers for European wars

14. The 1946 Burns Constitution reveals that the British were primarily concerned with…
   A. completely transferring political power to educated Africans
   B. eliminating traditional authorities from governance
   C. ensuring equal representation between Africans and Europeans
   D. maintaining control while creating limited African participation

15. What does the Bond of 1844 reveal about British colonial strategies in the Gold Coast?
    A. A calculated approach to extend legal jurisdiction while acknowledging local customs
    B. A desire to completely replace traditional legal systems
    C. A plan to establish direct military rule throughout the territory
    D. An intention to quickly grant independence to the Gold Coast

16. The spread of European languages along the Gold Coast reveals that…
    A. African languages were systematically suppressed
    B. language adoption was primarily imposed through formal education
    C. the Portuguese language remained dominant before colonial rule
    D. trade interactions were the primary driver of European language adoption

17. Which of the following represents the most significant factor driving European presence on the Gold Coast?
    A. Humanitarian concerns for Africa's development
    B. Religious conversion of indigenous populations
    C. Economic interests and access to resources
    D. Scientific curiosity about African geography

18. Which of these statements best defines the relationship between nationalism and local political rights in the Gold Coast?
    A. Nationalism aimed to remove foreign rule and restore sovereign rights to the people
    B. Nationalism mainly focused on international recognition with little concern for local rights
    C. Nationalism primarily sought social reform rather than political representation
    D. Nationalism was exclusively concerned with military resistance against colonial powers

19. Which of these factors significantly fueled proto-nationalism?
    A. The discriminatory appointment of Europeans to positions despite qualified Africans
    B. The exclusive use of the English language in government documents
    C. Preference for imported goods over local products
    D. The requirement that all citizens pay the same tax rates

20. The failure of the Fante Confederacy reveals that early nationalist movements…
    A. Had incompetent African leaders to organize effective political structures
    B. Suffered internal divisions and insufficient resources that hindered unity
    C. Lacked popular support among ordinary citizens for self-government
    D. The military could not contest the superiority of the colonial powers

21. Which of these assessments of the post-WWII nationalism is most accurate compared to proto-nationalism?
    A. Post-WWII nationalism relied less on educated elites and more on traditional rulers
    B. Nationalism focused on economic rather than political reforms after the WWII
    C. Post-WWII nationalism was less international in scope but more locally organized
    D. Nationalism was more radical and demanded immediate independence after 1945

22. World War II specifically transformed the psychological barriers to independence movements because it...
    A. broke the myth of European superiority when Africans fought alongside Europeans
    B. created economic hardship that made independence seem risky
    C. demonstrated European technological superiority
    D. showed Africans how to organize military campaigns

23. If you were an European trader in the Gold Coast in 1947, which of these situations would most directly affect your business operations?
    A. Demands for increased African representation in the Legislative Council
    B. The Association of West African Merchants controlling trade
    C. Cutting down of cocoa trees due to swollen shoot disease
    D. The formation of inter-territorial youth movements

24. The most appropriate conclusion to be drawn about the colonial government's response to the 1948 Riots is that they ...
    A. refused to consider any reforms to the political system
    B. recognized the need for constitutional change through the Watson Commission
    C. increased military presence to prevent future disturbances
    D. attempted to strengthen traditional authorities against nationalist movements

25. Dr Kwame Nkrumah applied his political ideology in contrast to the UGCC leaders by...
    A. advocating for gradual constitutional reforms
    B. focusing on mass mobilization and immediate independence
    C. pursuing economic development before political independence
    D. working more closely with traditional chiefs

STUDENT'S ID NO:_____ SIGNATURE: _____

SECTION B

[75 MARKS]

Answer any THREE (3) questions from this section. All questions carry same marks.

1. (a) Explain the centralized political system in Ghana with specific reference to the Akan. (10 marks)
   (b) Discuss three (3) features of the non-centralized (acephalous) political system in Ghana. (15 marks)

2. (a) State five (5) factors that led to the rise of the Gonja Kingdom in the northern sector of Ghana (10 marks).
   (b) Discuss three (3) factors that led to the rise of the Akan states in the forest zone of Ghana. (15 marks)

3. Discuss five (5) features each of the British indirect rule and the French direct rule (assimilation) systems in West Africa (25 marks)

4. (a) State any five (5) features of proto-nationalism in the Gold Coast (5 marks).
   (b) Examine any four (4) achievements of the Aborigines' Rights Protection Society (ARPS) (20 marks).

5. (a) State any five (5) features of the 1948 Riots in the Gold Coast. (10 marks)
   (b) Examine any three (3) factors that led to Dr. Kwame Nkrumah's breakaway from the UGCC. (15 marks)

Q2b

1' effective leadership
2) strong military organization
3) Trade routes'

2a

1. Strong military rule
2) Trade
3) Leadership skills
4)

4 traditional system were utilized

4b

4b 1) education and culture
2) preservation of the country's forest.
3) the withdrawal of 1897 land bill
4) united front.

Examiner: K. Adum-Kyeremeh, PhD

Q3a

1' Native Court were used in administration.
2) Chiefs were used in administration.
3) British supervision